

HamQuest of SPLORR!!

Player's manual: how to play, and how to read the screen

thegrumpygamedev.itch.io/hamquest-of-splorr

The goal

You are alone in a maze of 8 by 8 rooms and passages. Every dead end is a locked room. Somewhere in those rooms lie **16 pieces of the MegaHam**. Collect all of them, take the **Rainbow Key** from the **Summoner**, and walk into the **exit** (it is in a dead end too). Anything else you pick up along the way is there to keep you alive until then.

> **You start with** 5 health, a dagger, five hams, three potions, some clothes, a match and a torch. Each level adds one health. The game is hard on purpose: many new characters die in their first few rooms. Avoid fights you cannot win, find better gear, and eat.

The game saves itself in your browser as you play, so closing the page does not lose your place. If you die, the run is over: the next game is a new maze.

The screen



The whole screen. The numbers match the list below.

1	**The room.** The map of the room you are in, 15 by 15 tiles. It is dark: you only see what your light reaches, so a torch shows more than a match. Monsters outside your light are not drawn.
2	**The minimap.** The maze, 8 by 8 rooms. Only rooms you have been in are drawn. See the next page.
3	**Inventory.** What you carry. Every kind of item has a fixed slot; the number is how many you have.
4	**Statistics**: attack, defence, health, speed, experience and level.
5	**Fight mode**: the sword (attack) or shield (defend) is outlined. It decides which gear the game picks first. Tab switches.
6	**Messages.** The latest things that happened; a long one wraps onto a second line. The colour hints at the kind: blue is ordinary, red is experience.

Reading the minimap

The minimap is your map of the maze: each room you have visited is a small square in the grey panel, and it fills in as you explore. A room shows its **shape**, its **open sides**, any **locked doors** and a **marker**.

Shapes and sides

	**A chamber** (a room). The dark bars on the edge show which sides open onto a neighbouring room.
	**A passage.** A narrower connection, usually between other rooms.
	**A chamber that holds a piece of the MegaHam.** Only shown while you carry the Ring of Detection.
	**You are here.** The white and magenta box on a room is your current room.
	**A dead end with its door.** Dead ends have one way in and it is locked. The coloured bar on the side is the lock; its colour tells you which key opens it.

Door colours

Six locks, six keys; the colour on the minimap, on the door and on the key match.

carnelian	citrine	jade	aquamarine	sapphire	amethyst
					

					
					

Doors (top) and the key for each (bottom), same order. A key is used up when it opens a door. Doors stand in the room beside the dead end, and keys always lie in rooms that are not dead ends.

Markers

A small coloured mark in the corner of a room tells you what it holds right now:

	Monsters		Items lying on the floor
	The exit		A portal
	Monsters and items		Monsters and the exit
	Monsters and a portal		The exit and items
	The exit and a portal		Items and a portal

Markers are live: they show what a room holds *right now*, for every room you have visited, even across the maze.

Inventory and statistics



The inventory grid. Letters are columns, numbers are rows.

Reading a slot

Each kind of thing has its own square, so the key to a red door is always in the same place. The small number is how many you carry. A **teal frame** means it is in use (your weapon, your armour, your light). A **red or yellow bar** on an item in use means it is nearly worn out: yellow under half, red under a quarter.

Counts abbreviate: 1.5K is fifteen hundred, 12K twelve thousand.

Statistics (bottom right)

	**Attack**: the dice you roll with your weapon. No weapon is 0 (you can still punch).
	**Defence**: the most your armour can absorb from one hit.
	**Health**: what you have left, over the most you can have.
	**Speed**: the moves in this turn.
	**Experience**: points over the amount for the next level.
	**Level**.

What every slot is

Slot		Item	What it does
A1		dagger	Weapon: 1 attack dice.
B1		shortsword	Weapon: 2 attack dice.
C1		longsword	Weapon: 3 attack dice.
D1		two-handed sword	Weapon: 4 attack dice.
E1		battleaxe	Weapon: 8 attack dice.
A2		shield	Shield armour.

B2		helmet	Helmet armour.
C2		chainmail	Torso armour.
D2		platemail	Torso armour.
E2		boots	Feet armour.
A3		torch	Light source.
B3		lantern	Light source.
C3		magic lantern	Light source.
D3		lovely ham	Eaten by itself when you are hurt: heals 1 each.
E3		crimson potion	Used by itself when you would die: heals 10.
A4		carnelian key	Opens carnelian (red) doors. Used up when it opens one.
B4		citrine key	Opens citrine (yellow) doors.
C4		jade key	Opens jade (green) doors.
D4		rainbow key	Needed at the exit. Carried by the Summoner.
E4		Amulet of Yendor	Blocks portals and teleporting monsters, but you cannot leave the maze while you carry it. Press Y to put it down and be carried off.
A5		aquamarine key	Opens aquamarine (cyan) doors.
B5		sapphire key	Opens sapphire (blue) doors.
C5		amethyst key	Opens amethyst (magenta) doors.
D5		thieves' tools	Disarms a trap you walk onto (used up).
E5		mysterious green liquid	Lets you eat a poison ham safely (used up).
A6		Ring of Detection	The Ring of Detection: quest rooms show on your minimap.
D7		piece of megaham	Piece of the MegaHam. You need all 16.
E7		pile of gold pieces	Money. Every coin pile you pick up is added to this.

How the rules work

Moves and turns

Every key press that does something is one **move**, and bumping into a wall or a locked door still counts. Your **speed** (the number next to the boot) is how many moves make a **turn**; it is rolled again at the end of each turn, between 2 and 12, and your armour changes it (see below). Your light burns a little at the end of every turn.

Monsters have their own speed. For every move you make, each monster in the room acts *its speed divided by yours* times. A fast monster against a slow, armoured you can hit you twice in a move.

Fighting

Walk into a monster to hit it. You roll a number of dice equal to your **attack**; each die has a one in two chance of hitting. Your hits minus a random **defence roll** from the monster is the damage. If that is zero or less you missed. With no weapon you have a one in six chance of scratching for 1.

Monsters hit you the same way: their attack dice, minus a defence roll from your armour (one roll per piece you wear). The points of damage your armour absorbs wear it down, and the damage you deal wears your weapon. Which gear you wear is picked for you: in attack mode a two-handed weapon wins and the shield stays off; in defend mode the shield stays on and you use the best one-handed weapon.

	Weapon	Attack dice	Lasts (damage dealt)	Held in	Price
	dagger	1	25	one hand	100
	shortsword	2	50	one hand	250
	longsword	3	75	one hand	500
	two-handed sword	4	100	two hands (no shield)	1000
	battleaxe	8	50	two hands (no shield)	not sold; found only

	Armour	Slot	Defence roll	Speed	Lasts (damage absorbed)	Price
(no icon)	clothes	Body	up to 2	three quarters	never wears out	you start with them
	helmet	Helmet	up to 1	no change	5	100
	shield	Shield	up to 1	no change	5	150

	chainmail	Torso	up to 1	three quarters	10	350
	platemail	Torso	up to 2	half	15	700
	boots	Feet	up to 0	twice as many moves per turn	5	250

Staying alive

- **Hams** are eaten automatically as soon as you are hurt and move: each heals one point.
- A **potion** is used automatically when a hit would kill you, and restores 10. It saves you once per potion.
- **Rest** with Space: heals one point and finishes your turn, but only when no monster is in the room.
- Levelling up heals you completely. The first level needs 10 XP and every level after that needs twice as much.

Light

Everything beyond your light is black. A brighter light shows more of the room and more monsters before they reach you.

	Light	Brightness	Burns for	Price
	match	dimmest	never goes out; you always have it	-
	torch	level 1	25 turns each	100
	lantern	level 2	50 turns each	250
	magic lantern	level 3	100 turns each	750

Things you will meet

	**Doors.** Walk into one with the right key to open it. Without the key it just blocks you.
	**A piece of the MegaHam.** Pick up all 16. Each one you take wakes up some of the traps you have seen so far, so the maze gets more dangerous as you go.
	**The exit.** It only lets you through with all the pieces and the Rainbow Key, and never while you carry the Amulet.
	**A chest.** Walk into it to open it: something appears in its place (food, gold, a weapon, armour, a light, even a trap or a portal), and you walk onto it to take it.
Trap	**A trap.** Hidden until you stand next to it, then it shows as this. Walking onto one hurts; with thieves' tools in your pack it is disarmed and the tools are used up. Walking *around* it is free.
	**Ham.** A poison ham looks exactly like a lovely one. Walking onto it without the mysterious green liquid (the antidote) hurts you; goblins drop them now and then.
	**A portal.** Throws you to a random room, once (the portal is used up). Useful for escape, a nuisance when you wanted to be here. The Amulet makes you immune.
	**The Amulet of Yendor.** Protects you from portals and teleporting monsters, but you cannot leave while you hold it. Y drops it and sends you away.
	**The Ring of Detection.** Shows the rooms that hold pieces of the MegaHam on your minimap.

Shops

There are four shops, each in a dead end. A shop sells what its shelves happen to hold when you enter (the stock is random), and it **disappears once you have been in it**, so spend what you can. Entering a shop makes noise: expect more monsters to find you afterwards.

	Ye Olde Toole Shoppe	torch (100), lantern (250), magic lantern (750), thieves' tools (50)
	Ye Olde Weapon Smithy	dagger (100), shortsword (250), longsword (500), two-handed sword (1000)
	Ye Olde Armoury	shield (150), helmet (100), chainmail (350), platemail (700), boots (250)
	Ye Olde Potion Shoppe	lovely ham (25), crimson potion (150)

Prices in gold. Gold piles are about 26 to 50 gold each, and every coin you pick up goes into one total.

The monsters

Attack dice each hit on one chance in two. Defence is the largest number the monster can roll to cancel your hits. Speed is its actions per *your* turn. Most monsters drop something when they die: coins, food, and often better weapons and armour than you will find on the floor. **Wandering monsters:** the more often you walk through a room, the likelier a monster appears there.

	Monster	Attack	Health	Speed	Defence up to	XP	Notes
	skeleton	2 dice	1	6	2	1	Plentiful and fragile.
	zombie	2 dice	1	5	3	1	Slow.
	goblin	2 dice	1	10	1	1	Many of them, and quick. Sometimes drops ham (not always the good kind).
	ork	3 dice	1	8	2	1	Often carries a torch, a shield or a dagger.
	mummy	3 dice	2	4	4	2	Slow but hits hard for its health.
	fimir	3 dice	2	6	3	2	Sometimes carries a lantern or chainmail.
	ghoul	3 dice	3	8	4	3	Drains your experience points when it hits.
	chaos warrior	4 dice	3	7	4	3	Often guards armour or a good sword.
	thief	2 dice	2	18	4	2	Very fast. Steals gold, and now and then a piece of the MegaHam (which goes back into the maze).
	gargoyle	4 dice	3	6	5	3	Tough for its size.
	teleport monster	5 dice	1	12	0	1	Teleports you to another room when it hits (the Amulet blocks it).
	minotaur	4 dice, 2 attacks	10	6	4	10	Two attacks every time. Carries a battleaxe.
	necromancer	1 dice	8	4	2	8	Calls more of the dead to fight beside it. Carries the Amulet of Yendor.
	summoner	1 dice	10	6	2	10	Calls monsters to fight beside it. Carries the Rainbow Key.
	red dragon	10 dice	20	8	6	20	The strongest thing in the maze, and it hits hard.

Controls

Action	Keyboard	Touch
Move, or attack what is in the way	↑ ↓ ← → or W A S D	Tap toward where you want to go, or use the pad
Rest (needs a quiet room)	Space	Tap yourself, or the Rest button
Switch attack and defend gear	Tab	Tap the sword or shield icon, or Mode
Use the Amulet (drop it and be teleported)	Y	Amulet
New game	F2 (asks first)	New
Credits	C	Credits
Full screen	F	
Close a pop-up or screen	Enter or Esc	Tap
Stop the tip pop-ups for good	T while one is open	
In a shop: choose, buy one, buy all, leave	↑ ↓, Enter, A, Esc	Tap a row (again to buy), or a button

Tips

- Do not fight at the start. Walk away from what you do not have to kill; a fast monster is only dangerous while you are slow.
- Boots double your moves per turn. Platemail halves them. Heavy armour makes everything else around you act more often per move.
- Check the minimap before you open a door: a red mark means someone is in there.
- Each piece of the MegaHam you pick up wakes some of the traps you have seen: pick them up when you are healthy and have an exit.
- Keep one potion in reserve for the boss rooms. Dead ends are where the dangerous things live.
- Food and potions are cheap in the potion shop; buy before you need them.
- The Summoner and the Necromancer are the only monsters that call help. Kill them fast or leave.

Credits

Game, doors and walls: TheGrumpyGameDev. Tiles: David Gervais, Angband 32x32 tileset, Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 (creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0). Font: m5x7 by Daniel Linssen (managore), CC0. The 2026 Odin and WebAssembly port was written with Claude Code (Anthropic). The original game is a C# program written between 2007 and 2011 (WinForms, then Silverlight). There is no sound in this build.